

Preface

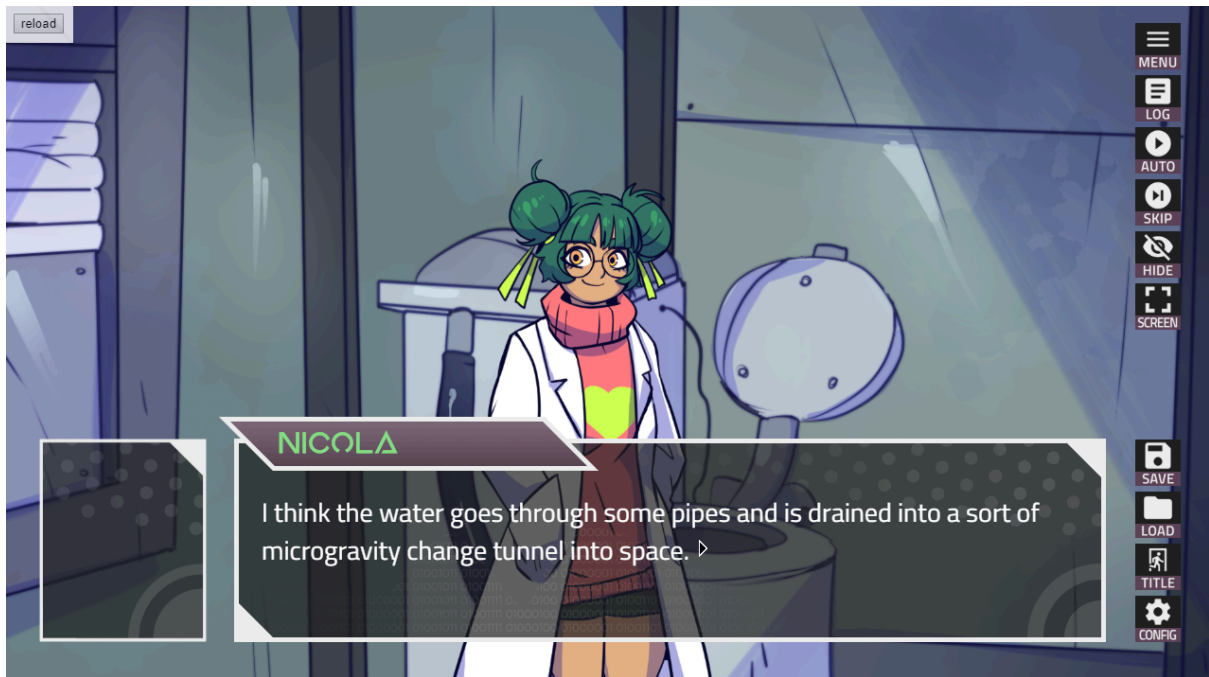
Stellar Sanctuary is a relatively short linear visual novel game. The absence of interaction and choices means that the interactivity is focused mainly on the feeling of the text, the audiovisual transitions from one scene to another, and the direct gamefeel & visuals of the presentation, meaning that the core focus of the interactivity lies there and nowhere else. Please refer to this documentation to grasp the most important needs of the game's feel.

Presentation

Stellar Sanctuary is a game focusing its visual aspects in two ways: ADV Style and SNL Style, switching back to back in the middle of conversations depending on the leading type of narration.

ADV Style

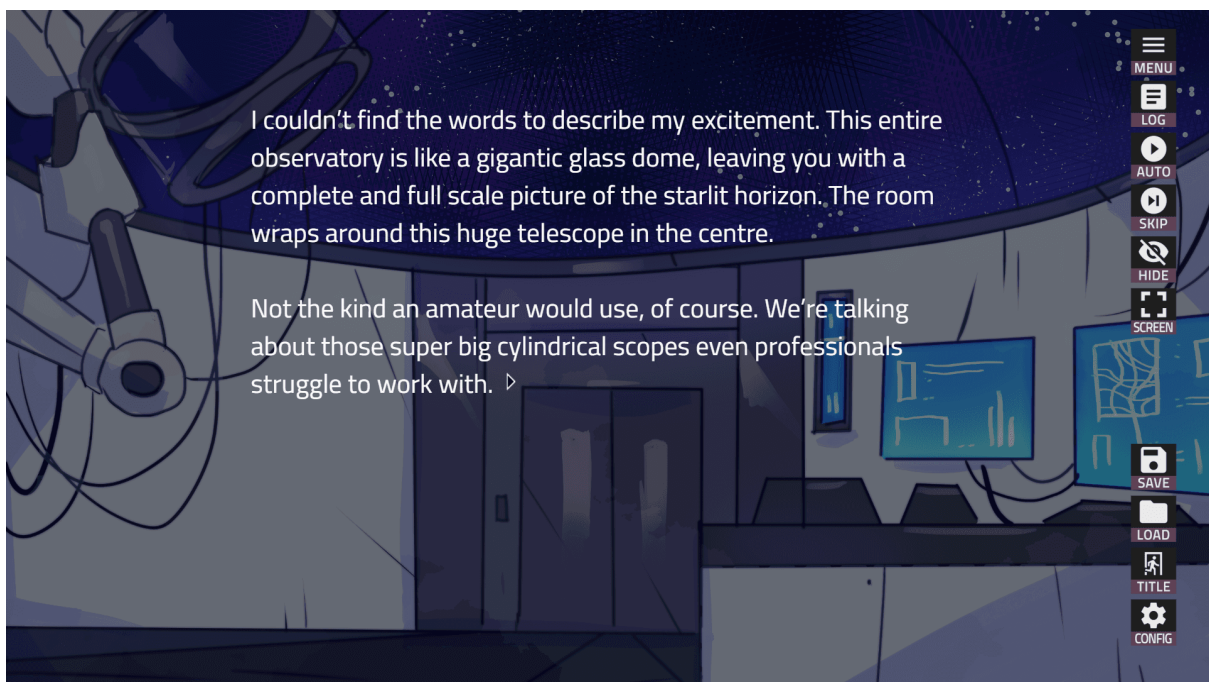




The ADV style is the visual style happening on screen whenever any character speaks (whether they are named or not, or is the protagonist). It displays:

- A general textbox containing the spelled out text in its main box element
- A colored upper box containing the character's name in a color code unique to the character in question
- A box to the left of the one containing the text, which contains Euphie's portraits whenever she speaks

SNL Style



The SNL style is the most visually traditional style of all - generally, it is simply going to be plain text in the middle of the screen, with a darker/dim black screen separating the text from the overall visuals (to make the text more readable). It is used for internal monologues from the main character, and those can last as little as a single line of text, or dozens of pages. Each paragraph is separated by line breaks & newlines.

Dynamic SNL Style



A more rare occurrence within the game (there will be less than 10 of those in the entire game) is the Dynamic SNL style. Much closer to the standard SNL style, but with the exception that it does display dialogues, and the names of the artist just before their actual lines, with color coded displayed names like in the ADV style. The internal monologues are displayed in italics. If it's possible to separate the dialogues from the internal monologues in a prettier way, like a slightly different font, it'd be even better.

Text Display

The way the text is intended to be displayed is very simple, but there are a few essential rules.

1. The game must **NEVER** display text in an "immediately aligned/centered" way within the center of the screen. It's hard to explain, and a visual cue is better to explain this:



Menu / General Behavior



Menu: Brings up the existing list of shortcuts here, but basically in a bigger menu. Puts emphasis on saving/loading, and maybe have a short description of each button. (*Shortcut: Right Click*)

Log: Shows the previously read text (*Shortcut: B & MouseWheel Up*)

Auto: Automatically reads the text. A visual cue on the screen could help to know whether or not this feature is activated or not. (see more in options) (*Shortcut: A*)

Skip: Accelerates the text AND scene playback. It needs to go very fast, without skipping *everything*. It could perhaps behave as if the text displayed immediately and was immediately skipped to the next line? (*Shortcut: CTRL*)

Hide: Hide all UI & text elements on the screen, including the black screen. Basically all that remains is the sprites, backgrounds and CGs. (*Shortcut: X and DEL*)

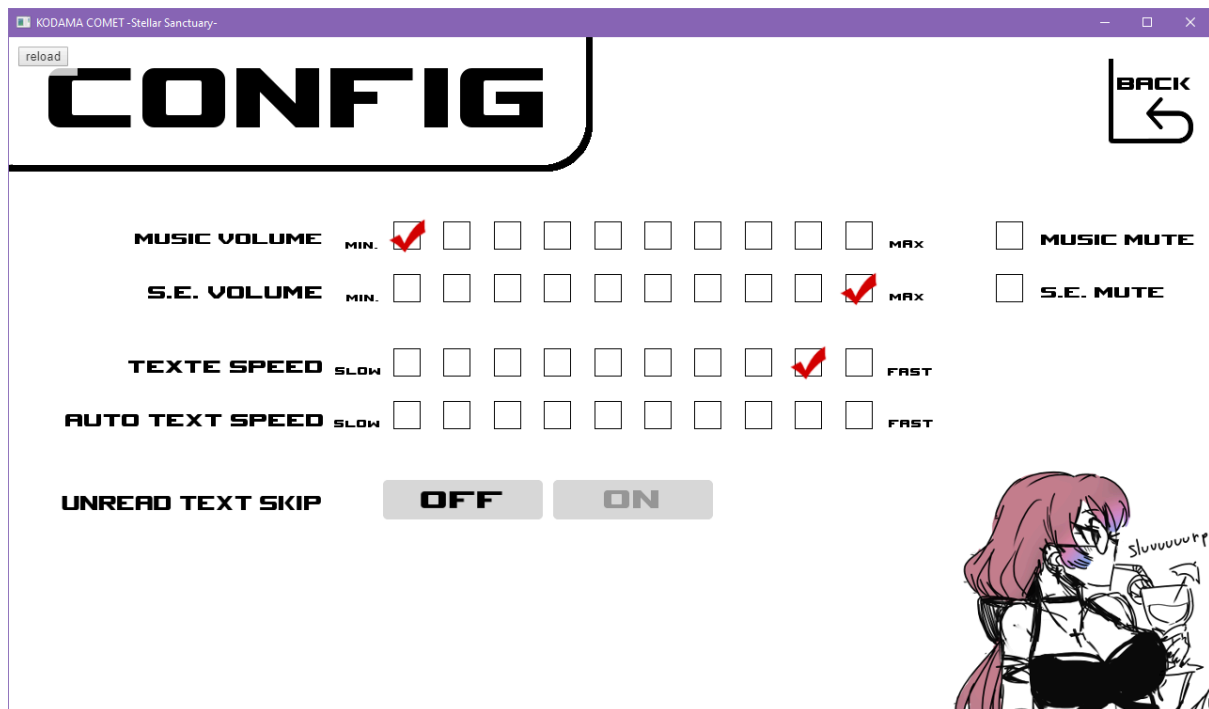
Save: Opens the save to file menu (*Shortcut: S*)

Load: Opens the load file menu (*Shortcut: L*)

Title: Goes back to the title screen - give a save prompt: "Going back to the title screen will make you lose progress" ; Options: Save & Go Back to Title / Go back to title without saving / Cancel (*Shortcut: T*)

Options (formerly config): Opens the options menu (*Shortcut: O*)

Options (config)



General option menu, which lets you customize:

- the volume of the BGM and SFX (seperately). A % gauge is better than buttons, but whatever works
- Customize the speed the text displays when the game is skipped to a next line
- Customize the time window before it skips to the next line in “auto” mode
- Ignore “unread text skip”, it’s a linear visual novel with no choices, so it doesn’t matter
- Maybe add an option to autosave every subchapter, on by default?
- Maybe an option to change the button layout?

Hurdles

1. The main difficulty from using TyranoBuilder was how to properly make the ADV style, especially for Euphie’s portraits displaying properly whenever she speaks. I want the game to have the ability to hide its UI, meaning everything from the UI like buttons, and textbox, **and the portrait displaying Euphie’s expressions**. Which was something that I unfortunately could never properly do within TyranoBuilder, since the native “Hide text/UI” mechanic means just deleting the interface. The issue being... Euphie’s expressions were not considered part of the interface, and were just displayed as traditional images. I want this to be possible in this new version of the game.
2. A text-log is imperative. Dynamic jumps would be perfect, but a simple text log in a big window is just as fine.
3. Transitions are important, and ideally, whenever a character changes expressions or moves, it’d be for the best if the text could disappear - including the SNL style black screen, and all of the text boxes in ADV mode. The UI on the right should stay, but maybe interaction should be locked out whenever a transition happens.